NWD Consulting Network, S.L.U.

Bringing the Education back to EdTech

Product Insights · Measurement & Research Design · Course and Curriculum Development

AI, Community, and Culture

A 6-Week Community Workshop on the Myths and Magic of AI

Ages 12+ | **6 weeks · 1 day per week** | **1–2 hours per session** | **Bring a phone or laptop**

This six-week workshop brings together people of all ages to explore the myths and magic of AI. The industry often uses complicated language to frame AI as some kind of wizardry, but many of these concepts are things we are already trying at home! By exposing what is behind the the smoke and mirrors, we make AI more approachable and open up space for the hard conversations: between parents and kids, teachers and students, and across our wider community. How do we think about AI without letting it think for us? How do we talk about its risks, its potential, and its place in our lives?

We begin with the basics of how large language models (LLMs) work, then explore hallucinations and AI errors before opening the floor to community-led philosophical discussions about AI's role in society. The final two classes focus on critical thinking and evaluation, exploring how teachers can design more AI-resistant assignments and how we can all learn to question, challenge, and work with these tools without surrendering our own thinking.

Week 1 · What Is AI?

- Tokens? RAG? Multi-shot prompts? Demystifying the jargon.
- Building a model: what goes in and what comes out.
- Tokens and why we use them.
- **Community Centered Philosophy:** Now that we know how AI works, what do you think that means for your community and culture?

Week 2 · Hallucinations and Model Collapse

- Why AI-generated content gets labeled, and how watermarks work.
- Getting your money's worth: stop paying extra for LLM wrappers.
- Taking the disclaimer seriously.
- **Community and Philosophy:** Everyone knows about hallucinations, who should be responsible for verifying the output?

Week 3 · Online Safety: Adults and Children

- AI and personally identifying information.
- Who owns your input and your output?
- What are bots?
- **Community and Philosophy:** What are some ways we can keep our selves, our children, and our communities safe in online environments?

Week 4 · Is AI Really Going to Take Our Jobs?

- Human vs. AI: who does it better?
- Enhancing your workflow with AI.
- Working beside AI without outsourcing your thinking.
- **Community and Philosophy:** In what ways can AI benefit your immediate community and when should you be wary?

Week 5 · Using AI at Work and in the Classroom

- Compare LLM performance on writing tasks.
- How and when to fact-check AI output.
- Skills for the community:
  - **Teachers:** building AI-proof assignments.
  - **Students:** why your teacher is annoyed when you use AI to write your homework.
  - **Workers:** improving your workflow without making a mess.
- **Community and Philosophy:** How does AI output compare to the writing of literary greats like Rosalia de Castro and Eduardo Pondal? How can we encourage young authors to maintain their voice when writing?

Week 6 · Using AI's Weaknesses Wisely

- Skill beats shortcuts: using AI better than the next person.
- Skills for the community:
  - **Teachers:** a quick lesson in psychometrics and test design.
  - **Students:** how AI-generated assessments can be gamed, and why that matters.
  - **Workers:** understanding skills tests and resume filters.
- **Community and Philosophy:** How does AI literacy give you a competitive advantage over your peers in the classroom and in the workplace?

No technical background needed—just curiosity and a willingness to join the conversation.

Interested in bringing this workshop to your community?

Contact us to schedule an intake interview and we'll find the right team for your needs.